

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Let's take a closer look at the life of Mozart!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe issues relating to money, in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Is classical music still relevant today? Why or why not?
- Which celebrities have died under mysterious circumstances?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about fame and work.
- I can talk about what is being done or what has been done.
- I can speculate about the past.

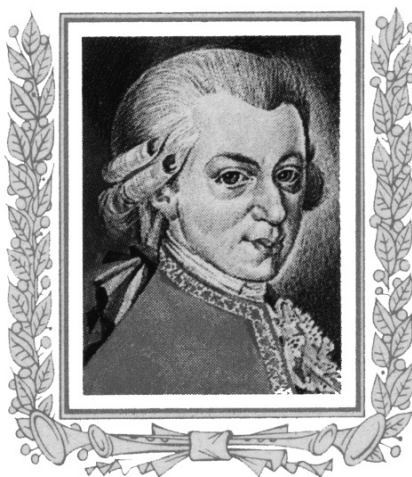




Let's Explore!

It's a **classic tale*** of murder and mystery!

* A "classic tale" is a story which is well known.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Could Mozart really have been murdered? Might poison have been the cause of his death? For centuries, these questions have been pondered by biographers and historians. They are difficult to answer, especially since new information regarding his life is constantly being uncovered.

Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart was born in Salzburg, Austria, in 1756. Even when he was very young, everyone could see that he was a musical genius. His father, a musician and composer, took his five-year-old prodigy on a tour of Europe to play in concerts. Wolfgang amazed kings, queens, and their courts with his musical ingenuity. As an adult, however, Mozart never earned enough to pay for his luxurious lifestyle. While he was being venerated by critics and the public for his musical acumen, Mozart's financial situation was becoming worse and worse. In 1791, at the age of thirty-five, the great virtuoso died as a poor man without even enough money to put a name on the gravestone.

Ever since, it has been speculated that his death may not have been entirely natural. Some have suggested that he may have been poisoned by a jealous counterpart, or that he could have been murdered by angry debt collectors.

The idea that Mozart might have been murdered is not new. It has been explored in print, by the great Pushkin, and in film, by Milos Forman. It is interesting to think that while his music is being enjoyed by millions around the world, his death is being contemplated by an inquisitive few.



Let's Practice!

Speculating about Mozart's mysterious demise.

Instructions: Use the words from the box to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

might / have / could / been / might have

- _____ Mozart really have been murdered?
- _____ the poison have been the cause of his death?
- His death may not _____ been entirely natural.
- He may have _____ poisoned by a jealous counterpart.
- The idea that Mozart _____ been murdered is not new.



Let's Practice!

Searching for genius.

Instructions: Read the clue. Find the words in the word search below.

Word Bank

- Biographer
- Historian
- Composer
- Genius
- Prodigy
- Venerated
- Ingenuity
- Acumen
- Virtuoso

Z	Q	R	N	I	W	W	V	R	U	M	Z	D	Q	Y
Z	H	I	S	T	O	R	I	A	N	U	L	M	S	A
T	J	F	B	R	L	Y	G	I	D	O	R	P	R	C
U	B	R	D	V	A	D	X	R	C	I	Y	T	E	D
N	I	A	F	E	X	R	M	Q	O	J	J	M	S	Q
S	O	K	K	N	B	D	Z	W	S	Q	X	T	O	E
R	G	V	L	E	V	O	B	L	O	K	Y	A	P	V
O	R	T	L	R	D	Q	E	B	U	W	T	F	M	O
L	A	I	U	A	W	B	M	V	T	F	I	D	O	J
R	P	S	U	T	H	Q	F	Z	R	U	U	G	V	A
L	H	U	O	E	D	U	A	Q	I	U	N	L	M	G
M	E	I	Z	D	S	M	H	K	V	I	E	G	V	W
R	R	N	A	C	U	M	E	N	K	C	G	K	G	S
U	M	E	G	N	G	V	U	E	H	S	N	R	G	C
U	C	G	D	C	S	G	H	L	G	J	I	C	W	H



Extension Activity

Conspiracy theory! Speculate on the reasons behind the death or disappearance of a well-known celebrity by creating a list of theories.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose a celebrity who died or disappeared under mysterious circumstances (e.g. Mozart, Elvis, Amelia Earhart).
- Provide some background information on your celebrity.
- Explain the death or disappearance by creating a list of possible explanations by speculating about the past. (Use *might have*, *may have* and *could have*.)
- Present your ideas to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I read about famous celebrity mysteries.

☐ ☐

I research a famous person.

☐ ☐

I speculate about the past with "might have, may have and could have."

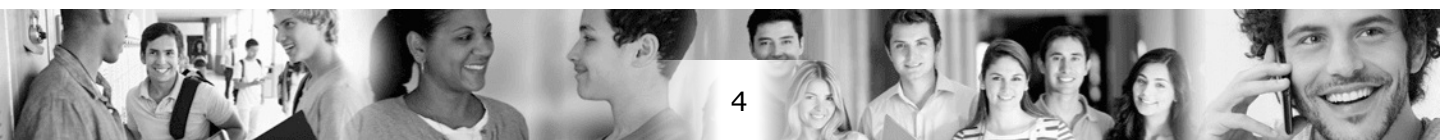
☐ ☐

I share my ideas with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- biographer** (noun): an author who writes the story of someone's life
e.g. Biographers have studied the life of Mozart.
- historian** (noun): a person who studies history
e.g. These questions have been pondered by historians.
- composer** (noun): a person who writes music
e.g. His father was a musician and a composer.
- genius** (noun): exceptional intelligence or ability
e.g. Everyone could see that he was a musical genius.
- prodigy** (noun): a young person with exceptional abilities
e.g. He took his five-year-old prodigy on a tour of Europe to play in concerts.
- ingenuity** (noun): the ability to think of new and clever ways of doing things
e.g. Wolfgang amazed kings, queens, and their courts with his musical ingenuity.
- venerated** (adjective): extremely respected or honored
e.g. He is Germany's most venerated musician.
- acumen** (noun): skill in a particular subject
e.g. He was praised by critics and the public for his musical acumen.
- virtuoso** (noun): a person who is extremely skilled, usually at playing an instrument or performing
e.g. At the age of thirty-five, the great virtuoso died.





Learning Points

Speculation About the Past

You can use modals to talk about degrees of certainty and speculate about things in the past.

You use them to describe what is definite, probable, possible, or impossible from the speaker's point of view.

You can use *must*, *may*, *might*, and *could* to describe degrees of certainty.

You can use modals with the Present Perfect to talk about the possibility of a past event that is not clear in the present context.

Example:

Might poison ***have been*** the cause of his death?*

*Notice the structure of a question.

Look at the chart for the meanings of modals when speculating about the past:

Modal Phrase	Meaning
Must have	It is very likely.
May have Might have Could have	It is possible.

- *May have* has a slightly stronger meaning than *might have* or *could have*.
- You can add **not** to make a negative speculation (*It **may not have been** true*).

Examples:

- *Ever since, it has been speculated that his death may not have been entirely natural.*
- *Some have suggested that he may have been poisoned by a jealous counterpart, or that he could have been murdered by angry debt collectors.*
- *The idea that Mozart might have been murdered is not new.*



Learning Points

The Passive: The Present Continuous and Present Perfect Tenses

You use the Present Continuous to talk about an action that is happening at the time of speaking. The action or event is in progress.

*Millions of people around the world **are enjoying** his music.*

You use the Present Perfect to talk about a finished action or event with present consequences. There is a connection between what happened in the past and the present.

*The great Pushkin **has explored** the murder of Mozart.*

You often choose the passive form when you want to talk about an action but are not so interested in saying who or what does/did it. Passives without *agents* (the doers) are common in biographies.

Look at the chart below for the structure of the passive voice.

Name	Structure	Example
Present Continuous	am/are/is + being + past participle	<i>His death is being contemplated by an inquisitive few.</i>
Present Perfect	have/has + been + past participle	<i>It has been explored in print, by the great Pushkin, and in film, by Milos Forman.</i>

Examples:

- *Ever since, it has been speculated that his death may not have been entirely natural.*
- *It is interesting to think that while his music is being enjoyed by millions around the world, his death is being contemplated by an inquisitive few.*

